



Palit HD 4870 Sonic 1GB

From 512 MB to 1 GB

The HD 4870 initially launched with only a 512MB GDDR5 version, which was just odd, because such a high-power card deserved to have more memory. Months after the first 4870s came, we see companies coming out with 1-GB versions, one of them being the Palit with its Sonic edition 4870 1 GB card.

Palit has not stuck with the standard cooling edition, but has gone in for the same dual-fan cooling like some of the other Sonic series cards. The card has two 6-pin PCIe power connectors towards the back. Now, when you look at the I/O side of this card, it gets a bit more interesting. Palit has moved on from that boring Dual Link DVI setup seen on most graphic cards these days.

Instead, we see four different ports – DVI, VGA, HDMI and a new standard display port. There is a small overclocking switch to go from Normal to Turbo mode. Under Normal, the core clocks at 750MHz and memory at 3800MHz QDR. When you hit the Turbo switch, the card automatically adjusts its core to 775 MHz and Memory to 4000 MHz QDR. It's not a very large overclock, but it's good to have.

The card gave us a 3D Mark 06 score of 15087. We benchmarked Crysis in DX9 at 1280x1024 and 1920x1200 both at 4x AA and 4x AF and got fps ratings of 46 and 30, respectively. Unreal Tournament 3 gave us an fps of 115 at 1280x1024 and 69 at 1920x1200 both at 4x AA and 4x AF. With Doom 3 (4x AA) at 1600x 1200, we got 200.5 fps. In Prey, we got 125.5 fps at 1920x1200 and 4x AA, 4x AF. We tested in turbo mode and it did not give us great gains.

The only drawback we noticed with this card is

that the it's slightly louder than most cards, especially louder in turbo mode where the fans throttle up to the overclock. At Rs 18,500, the card is great buy for a high-end card.

Specifications
Memory Support: 1024 MB
DDR5, Memory Interface: 256 bit, Sonic Memory / Core Clock: 3800 MHz (950 x 4) / 750 MHz, Turbo Memory / Core Clock: 3800MHz (950 x 4) / 775 MHz

Contact: Tirupati Enterprises
Phone: 09339207519
E-mail: mail@tirupati.net
Web site: www.tirupati.net
Price: Rs. 18,500



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

WD My Passport Elite 500GB

Slim, portable and spacious

Portable hard drives are getting smaller and smaller and everybody wants storage. Western Digital has added a 500 GB drive to the My Passport Elite series. This drive design is great as always and has a soft finish to it.

The WD My Passport Elite is a 2.5-inch drive with a nice metallic finish to it with the edge in a black gloss finish. On one side, you find the USB 2.0 connector with four white LEDs next to it. We noticed a flaw here, the lights are on the connecting side of the drive, that means the user can't really see the lights. The lights should have been on the other side so that users can actually see them. There is also a sliding cover over the USB port which is quite innovative and keeps the port safe and clean.

The My Passport Elite was quiet, and in HDTach, it scored an average read speed

of 34.9 MBps, and an average write speed of 29.1 MBps. In SiSoft Sandra, the drive Index score was 31 MBps. We ran the drive through some file transfer test where we did a 1 GB sequential as well as a 1 GB assorted file transfer test and got the following times – 1 GB sequential write time: 36.5 sec, 1 GB sequential read time: 16.4 sec, 1 GB sequential internal copy: 44.7 sec. For the 1 GB assorted files we got a write time of 42.7 sec, a read time of 16.1 sec, and 1 GB assorted internal copy: 38.1 sec.

This portable drive also comes with software that includes Google Desktop, Picasa, Adobe Reader 8.1, WD Diagnostics Setup, Backup Utility, Drive Manager, MioNet and a Sync Tool. With

466 GB of actual storage space, this drive is great for its design and build quality. It has a 5-year warranty, but unfortunately, the price tag of Rs. 12,150, it's certainly not good value for money.

Specifications
Dimensions: 15 x 126.15 x 79.5 mm, 2.5 inch SATA 5400 RPM

Contact: Western Digital
Phone: 09321029204
Email: amarjeet.singh@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com
Price: Rs. 12,150

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★



MSI PR201

The Plain Jane laptop

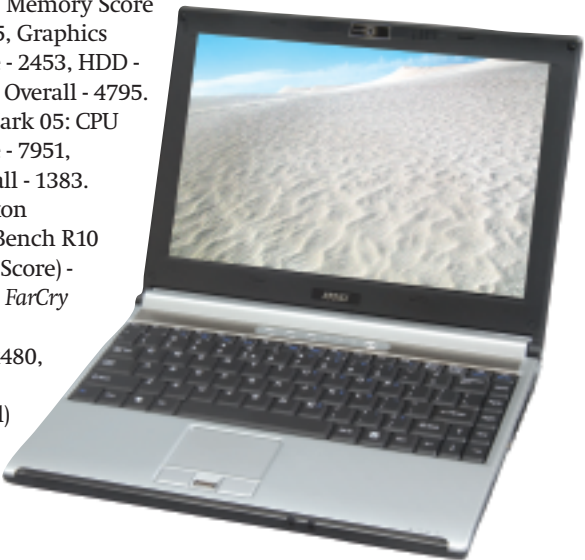
The MSI PR201 notebook falls in the Professional series of the MSI group. The PR201 is black, like other business notebooks, but has nice silver insides. This gives a really neat and simplistic feel to it, and you won't even find stickers of any kind on it.

There is a Kensington security slot, VGA port, USB, LAN port, and an optical drive on the left side. The right side of the laptop has two USB ports, a modem port, an HDMI port, a PC card slot and a flash card reader.

A few problems we had with this laptop was that firstly the touchpad has no side scrolls or multi-touch functions. Even though this laptop may be going for a plain and neat look, things like that may be

beneficial at times. This MSI also lacks a FireWire port. We ran a series of benchmarks to see the performance of this laptop.

PC Mark 05: CPU Score - 5800, Memory Score - 4885, Graphics Score - 2453, HDD - 4461, Overall - 4795. 3D Mark 05: CPU Score - 7951, Overall - 1383. Maxxon CineBench R10 (CPU Score) - 4694. FarCry (fps) (640x480, low detail)



- 51.41. The screen quality is just about decent and if it were a rating on 10 we would give it a 6.5, whereas the audio would score a 7.

There are two things that stand out in this laptop. One is the battery life: It lasted a whole 3 hours 27

mins on high performance with full brightness. The second being it's weight: 1.8 kg. The laptop is definitely business oriented and has great processing power. But then it also lacks some features like a better touchpad and a better optical drive also.

Specifications
Intel Core 2 Duo P8400 @ 2.26 GHz, Display: 12-inch WXGA (1280x800), SD, MMC, MS, MS PRO Card reader

Contact: MSI
Phone: 011-41758808
E-mail: marketing@msi-in.com
Web site: www.msi-in.com
Price: Rs. 62,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Samsung T220

Different, but at a cost

With brands lowering prices and a lot of choice available, Samsung's T220 moves away from the norm of plain thin bezel screens.

The T220 is identical to its 19-inch sibling – the

T190 which came to us a few months back. In terms of design, things aren't any different. The Bordeaux treatment is still there. There bezel around the screen is semi-transparent with a hint of color thrown

in. The power button is using a touch-sensitive button. The menu controls are on the side.

The build quality of the screen itself is great but the stand isn't so. The stand only allows you to move the screen back and forth quite a bit.

The display quality is somewhat similar to what the T190 has. Calibrating the screen using Displaymate was a little tricky with the brightness and contrast settings not playing along well. The blacks aren't very deep and the colors are pretty decent overall. Being a TN panel, banding is present, but not visible as much in all colours. Movies and games look fine but there is nothing extraordinary.

The T220 is destined for users who want their desktop setups to look good. The T220 is on target in that aspect, but the performance of the

screen is not as good as we'd like it to be. It's still an above average performer. The price is clearly more than most 22-inch screens. This is something that you should only spend on if you really want design and elegance.

Specifications
22-inch screen, Resolution: 1680x1050, Response time: 2ms, Dimensions: 20.47 x 17.4 x 8.46 inches

Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: rengith.nair@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com
Price: Rs 15,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

